

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1060

By Faison

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Ken Tarkington, Jr., for fifty-five years of service with the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it the privilege of the members of this General Assembly to specially recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to improving the quality of life for their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Ken Tarkington, Jr., who marks fifty-five years of service this year with the State of Tennessee, a milestone that serves as a testament to his competency and his devotion to serving others; and

WHEREAS, a resident of Forest Hills, Mr. Tarkington came on board with the State on June 24, 1971, as a Business Manager 1 with the Department of Correction; he soon ascended to the position of Business Manager 2, then Associate Warden 3 and Associate Warden 4; and

WHEREAS, he then transitioned to serve with the Tennessee Wildlife Resources Agency (TWRA) as Fiscal Director 1; his intermediate posts included Fiscal Director, Wildlife Manager 5, and Fiscal Director 3, which led to his current position as TWRA's Chief Budget Officer; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure with TWRA, he has served as a commissioned officer for the organization and given his personal time on weekends and holidays to complete boating officer work and work in deer check stations; he also attended Tennessee Law Enforcement Training Academy and took part in law enforcement in-service training, all in addition to his fiscal role at TWRA; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tarkington is a 1966 graduate of Battle Ground Academy and holds a bachelor's degree in business from Middle Tennessee State University; he is a licensed pilot and a veteran of the Tennessee Army National Guard and remains involved with the Employer

Support of the Guard and Reserve as the Communications Representative/Public Affairs Director; and

WHEREAS, he served with the National Guard and Army Reserve for thirty-seven years, attending Advance NCO School and the National Defense University and serving as a commissioned First Lieutenant in the Finance Corps of the Tennessee Army National Guard; and

WHEREAS, in addition to commendations for outstanding service, he received the prestigious Seven Seals Award for his leadership and initiative and support of the National Guard and Reserve, as well as the 2008 President's Volunteer Service Award, which he accepted in Washington, D.C.; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his many vocational pursuits, Ken Tarkington is a talented mechanic and a vintage car and vintage model train enthusiast; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many worthy endeavors, he has enjoyed the love and support of his wife of fifty-four years, Linda; together, they have been blessed with two children, Kennard (Jennifer) Tarkington III and Emily Tarkington, as well as four grandchildren, Hunter, Hannah, Hope, and Eva; and

WHEREAS, Ken Tarkington has distinguished himself as a public-spirited citizen of the highest order and as an exceptional asset to his community; and

WHEREAS, his remarkable success as a public servant and civic leader is directly attributable to his reliance on the time-honored values of hard work and common sense and his uncommon ability to work well with people from all walks of life; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tarkington is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Ken Tarkington, Jr., for fifty-five years of honorable and astute service to the good people of Tennessee and extend to him our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.